How We Want to Come Across — Plain Version

- **Requested by:** operator, via Telegram, 2026-09-30 — feedback on `docs/BRIEF_silicon-jungle-the-why.md` and the operator's own draft, "How We Want to Come Across": both still read as too jargon-heavy and academic for clear communication. This is a rewrite aimed at fixing that specific complaint.
- **What changed, and why:** the earlier drafts had good lines in them, but they were wrapped in a framework — numbered "cups," a translation table, a scoring checklist, audience-segmented message matrices. Frameworks are themselves a kind of jargon, even when every individual word is simple: they make a reader feel like they're in a workshop, not a conversation. This version keeps the good lines and drops the framework. It's meant to be read once, straight through, like someone talking.

We want to come across like a good host, not a salesperson

A good host knows the house, is glad you came, and isn't worried about whether you stay. A salesperson talks about what they built. A host talks about what's going to happen to you. That's the whole difference, and it's the only rule underneath everything else here.

The story, plainly

Todd spent thirty-eight years learning how to read an organization — a real method, used on more than five thousand companies, on five continents. It ended up locked inside old software almost nobody can open anymore, and Todd waited more than ten years for someone who could bring it back to life.

We knew that kind of waiting. For almost two years, one of us had been building a company alone, behind a screen, and had stopped moving.

So a group of builders got in a room for a weekend. By Sunday, Todd's life's work could talk. You'd speak to it for fifteen minutes, and it would ask you real follow-up questions and hand you back a reading of your organization that used to take a hundred and eighty questions on paper — the kind almost nobody finishes. Todd watched it happen. And the other stalled project came back to life in the same room, the same weekend.

That's the whole reason any of this keeps happening. We don't do it to make one more product. We do it to bring stuck work back to life.

What we've actually done, no more and no less

Eight weekends have happened. Four people became more than twenty, all building together. Two things grew up out of those weekends and turned around to help run them: Toddito, which reads organizations, and Keonda, which is starting to remember who in the community can help who.

That's it. That's not a metaphor for a bigger claim — it's the actual, current size of the thing.

What's still ahead, said plainly

Keonda isn't done — it doesn't yet fully remember who can help whom across the whole community. There's no reliable path yet from "came to a weekend" to "built a real company." We don't have a home that's full, with more people wanting in than we have room for. And we don't yet have proof in the form that matters most — paying customers, partnerships that hold.

We say this plainly because the honesty is the actual asset. Eight real weekends and a proven leap for Toddito are true and worth saying with confidence. Saying what's still missing, calmly, is what makes the rest believable.

The one line, if there's only room for one

Some of the best work in the world is stuck, waiting for the right room. We build the room.

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The slightly longer version, if someone wants it

We help people who already have their customers' trust turn it into a business, starting with one weekend. Code got cheap — anyone can build something in a weekend now. Trust didn't get any cheaper. So we spend our time near the people who already have it, and give them a room, a weekend, and the tools to build.

A few lines that already work, worth reusing as-is

- "Code got cheap. Trust didn't."
- "They bring the customers. We bring the tools."
- "Some of the best work in the world is stuck, waiting for the right room."
- "Come to the next one, and bring whatever you have."

How to actually talk about it, five habits

1. **Talk about the other person, not about what we built.** They're the one doing something real. We're glad to be there for it.
2. **Say three things, then stop.** If someone wants more, they'll ask. Answering a question nobody asked yet is the fastest way to sound like a pitch.
3. **Say what isn't finished yet, in the same calm voice as what is.** It's more convincing, not less — a claim with no gaps in it reads as a sales pitch, and people can tell.
4. **Talk about where someone's going, not what they're escaping.** "Bring your name and your customers, leave with a company" works better than "stop struggling alone."
5. **End with something small.** Never "join the platform." Just: come to the next weekend. A small, easy yes.

Two things still open before this goes further

- Todd hasn't given his own line yet, in his own words, and hasn't heard this story told back to him. That should happen before anyone else hears it.

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- The exact numbers — how many years, how many companies, how this compares to paid consulting work — aren't confirmed yet. Until they are, "decades of work" is the honest version; a precise-sounding number that isn't checked is worse than a plain one that is.

What this replaces

This stands in for the numbered "four cups" structure and the audience-message table in the operator's own draft, and for the more formal, structural sections of `docs/BRIEF_silicon-jungle-the-why.md`. Nothing in those documents was wrong — this version just says the same true things without the scaffolding around them, since the scaffolding was the actual complaint.

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